P07

Division of Labor and Plasticity in Social Insect Societies

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Domain DOM_BIO

Abstract

Social insect colonies exhibit flexible division of labor: workers dynamically switch roles in response to external perturbations and colony losses. Internal response thresholds mediate behavioral transitions, granting immense societal fault tolerance.

Abstract quoted from A. Beshers et al., Annual Review of Entomology (2001).

Notes: record the page or section for every claim you make about this paper.

Reading prompts

1. What is the core problem addressed and what assumptions are made?
2. What mathematical or structural abstractions represent the physical phenomena?
3. How can this concept be mapped or transferred to analogous problems in other domains?